INVENTORY · GRID · STRUCTURE

# cards-grid

2–4 parallel items, similar weight, scannable in a grid.

# A cards grid gives equal weight to peers.

**Parallel titles.**

Noun phrases of similar weight, never mixed.

**Short bodies.**

One clause each; a long card collapses the grid.

**Rank order.**

Left to right reads strongest first.

**Four cards.**

The hard ceiling; five means a new slide.

# four locks a two-by-two, compact tightens it.

**Quadrant read.**

Four cells scan as a loop.

**Compact pairing.**

Padding shrinks so labels stay whole.

**Named corners.**

Position carries meaning; place cards deliberately.

**Still four.**

The ceiling does not move.

# three widens the grid to three columns.

**Wider cards.**

Each card earns a third of the row.

**Same budget.**

Bodies stay one clause, titles stay parallel.

**Sweet spot.**

Three peers is the count this grid loves.

# An ordered list numbers the cards.

1

**Numbers appear**

Markdown's ordered list turns cards into steps.

2

**Sequence reads**

The grid now implies order, so mean it.

3

**Budget holds**

Same one-clause bodies as the unnumbered grid.

# Four full cards is this grid's loud maximum.

**Card one.**

A body at the hard budget runs this long — two clauses that read as one breath, and not a word more.

**Card two.**

Parallel structure matters most at the ceiling; matching shapes are what keep four dense cards readable as a set.

**Card three.**

The grid trades white space for words here; past this density the audience reads one card and skips the rest.

**Card four.**

The hard stop. A fifth card or a longer body does not fit — split the slide or reach for list-tabular.

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# When NOT to reach for cards-grid.

**More than 4 items**

Split into multiple slides instead. The grid loses scannability past 4 cards.

**Order carries meaning**

Use list-steps or `list takeaway numbered`. cards-grid is for parallel options, not sequences.

# When NOT to reach for cards-grid.

**Lopsided density**

Equalize the prose when one card has three sentences and the rest have one. Otherwise change layout.

**Inline-code-only body**

A body bullet containing only `code` gets promoted to an eyebrow label. Mix it with surrounding prose.

RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`list-steps` — items carry an explicit sequence

`cards-stack` — items stack vertically as full-width rows

`compare-prose` — two-option comparison, side by side

`verdict-grid` — comparing options against shared criteria